



Sourcing and receiving food and drink

K

Know

Useful things to know

- You need to know that all of the food, ingredients, inputs and packaging materials that are used in your food or drink are safe.
- Using [trusted suppliers](#) gives you confidence that the foods/ ingredients/inputs sourced are safe to use. This can save you time and money, and prevent people getting sick from your food.
- You need to check that the ingredients you receive are:
 - safe to use,
 - not damaged,
 - at the right temperature (if applicable),
 - not past their Use By date.



- If you are importing food, you need to complete a safety and suitability assessment and show that the food is safe. See mpi.govt.nz/safe-suitable-food/.



- Some foods must be kept cold (chilled or frozen) to stop bugs growing as they can become unsafe quite quickly if they're not kept at the right temperature.



It's best to be there to receive deliveries. If chilled or frozen food is delivered out of hours, how will you know that it was delivered at the right temperature, and if it's still safe to use?



- Dairy: There are specific rules for receiving milk for making raw milk cheese outlined in the **Do** section.



- Horticulture: You need to consider agricultural compounds (inputs), like herbicides, pesticides, fungicides and fertilisers in the same way other food businesses have to consider ingredients, additives and preservatives. You need to know what chemicals you got, from where, how much you used, that they are suitable for the crop you are using them on, when and where the crops have gone to. A spray diary is a good way to do this.



- Horticulture: Businesses sprouting seed for human consumption need to consider the seed as an ingredient. You need to make sure it has been produced specifically for human consumption, and that the risk of the seed becoming contaminated with Salmonella has been managed.

Why is this important?



- Horticulture: What happens on the farm (or immediately post-harvest) can affect the safety and suitability of horticultural produce.



- Wine: New Zealand has specified Maximum Residue Limits (MRLs) for certain agricultural chemicals:

www.mpi.govt.nz/agriculture/plant-products-requirements-and-pesticide-levels/pesticide-maximum-residue-levels-mrls-for-plant-based-food-for-nz-and-other-countries/pesticide-maximum-residue-level-legislation-around-the-world/. When buying commodities for wine you need to ensure they meet applicable MRLs.



- Wine: If you are exporting, the importing country may impose additional requirements for withholding periods/pre-harvest intervals and MRLs.

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Know



- Wine: If you buy in or import fruit, juice or bulk wine you need to know where it has come from and what has been added to it from your supplier.



- Grape wine: If exporting grape wine, you need to know where all of the wine has come from (including top ups) so that you can meet any applicable Overseas Market Access Requirements (OMARs).



- Wine: You need to check that any wine you buy and want to export has been made under a wine standards management plan (WSMP) that has been verified on an annual basis.

- Honey: Tutin is a natural toxin that can be present in honey. Honey packers need to be able to show that their honey meets the Tutin in Honey Standard: www.mpi.govt.nz/dmsdocument/11137-Food-Standard-Tutin-in-Honey.



D

Do

Rules you must follow

Sourcing



- Keep a list of your suppliers and their contact details.



- If you are importing food, you must register as a food importer with MPI, or contract the services of one. These requirements are outlined here: mpi.govt.nz/safe-suitable-food/



- If you are importing food, you will need to conduct a safety and suitability assessment of it before you import it. See the **Know** section for more information.



D

Do



- Dairy: You must tick which type/s of milk you are sourcing:

☐ Pasteurised

☐ Raw



- Dairy: Raw milk must come from a farm that has a Farm Dairy RMP.

- Grape wine: You must keep **records** including supplier details where grapes were grown, brand and batch ID's, Best Before and Use By dates (if required).



- Horticulture: Ensure any seed used for sprouts or microgreens has been produced specifically for human consumption.

Receiving

- You must always:
 - check the temperature of foods and inputs that need to be chilled to keep them safe. If it is above 5°C (or other temperature specified by the manufacturer), apply the 2 hour/4 hour rule as shown in the diagram below:

Applies to potentially hazardous food such as:



Soft cheese



Fresh tofu



Egg sandwich



Meat

Total time food is in the danger zone (5°C to 60°C)

What to do

More than 4 hours

Throw out

2 to 4 hours

Serve, or heat to 75°C
Do not chill

0 to 2 hours

Serve, or chill, or heat to 75°C

D

Do

- check that frozen food is frozen,
- ensure that packaging is not damaged or dirty,
- ensure that food is not past its Use By date.

- You must put chilled food and inputs away first, then frozen food, and then food that can be stored at room temperature.



- Dairy: Once received

- pasteurised milk must be stored at 6°C or less,
- pasteurised cream must be stored at 7°C or less, or
- other temperature combination approved by your registration authority



- Dairy: Once received

- raw milk must be stored at 6°C or less and processing (such as pasteurisation) must start within 5 days from first harvest or
- other time/temperature combination approved by your registration authority



- Cheese: Raw milk for raw milk cheese must come from a farm that has an RMP that covers harvesting and supply of raw milk for the manufacture of raw milk products.



- Raw milk for raw milk cheese that has not been received within 2 hours of milking must be received at:

- 8°C or less if cheesemaking starts within 4 hours, or
- 7°C or less if cheesemaking starts within 24 hours, or
- 6°C if cheesemaking starts within 48 hours.



- Milk for making raw milk cheese must be no more than 48 hours old.

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Do

0 to 2 hours

2 to 4 hours

4 to 48 hours

More than 48 hours

Any temperature

Less than 8°C

Less than 7°C within 3 hours of end of milking (daily collection)

Less than 6°C within 2 hours from end of milking (48 hours collection)

Can't be used for raw milk cheese



- Wine: When you receive grapes, fruit or other commodities for wine you must **record**:



- the supplier
- the date of receipt,
- the quantity any sprays or agricultural compounds (for example pesticides, herbicides insecticides or foliar sprays) applied (if applicable),
- whether any contamination has or may have occurred,
- if contamination has occurred, what was done to ensure that the commodity is fit for the intended purpose.



- Grape wine: When receiving grapes you must also **record**:



- withholding period for each spray used, and
- the last date each spray was used, and
- any other winemaking inputs applied in the field (for example sulphur dioxide additions).

D

Do



- Honey: You must be able to show that any honey you pack meets the Tuten in Honey Standard www.mpi.govt.nz/dmsdocument/11137-Food-Standard-Tuten-in-Honey. This can be done by keeping:



- test results
- **records** showing harvest at low-risk times
- **records** that show there was no significant tutu in the foraging area
- **record** of targeted testing that show a low risk of tutu.



S

Show



- Your verifier will ask you who your suppliers are and how you know that they are trusted suppliers.
- Wine: **Records** of all the information requested in the **Do** section about grapes, fruit or other commodities you have received



- Your verifier might:
 - watch what you do when receiving a delivery of food, ingredients or inputs at your business,
 - check your **records** relating to receiving food, ingredients or inputs,



- Show your verifier a **record** of:



- all of the information outlined in the **Do** section if you are importing food,
- all of the information in the **Do** section if you chose option 1, or
- the minimum information required listed in the **Do** section if you chose option 2.

S

Show



- Horticulture: Show or explain to your verifier:
 - how you know seed used for sprouts or microgreens is safe for human consumption,
 - how you know which agricultural compounds have been applied to crops, and how you know maximum residue levels are not exceeded.



- Honey: Your verifier will ask:
 - how you know any honey you extract or pack or sell meets the tutin standard.



- Honey: Your verifier will check:
 - any **records** and or supplier statements that honey you sell meets the tutin standard.

